

ODF Olympiad 2009

Winners to Get Netbooks!

It's heartening to hear of the West Bengal state government joining hands with the government of Malaysia and a host of other OSS stakeholders, to drive home the advantages of the ODF amongst students.

The ODF Olympiad (www.odfolympiad.org) was launched in 2006 as a global school-level competition. It started off, on the advice of India's earlier President, Shri A P J Abdul Kalam, with the goal of increasing awareness about open source software in schools. The 2008 edition of the ODF Olympiad witnessed participation from over 116 countries. The competition aims to showcase the ease of using cutting-edge ODF compliant software such as OpenOffice.org and to bring students and teachers closer to adopting free and open source software.

For the 2009 edition of the Olympiad, students of all the participating institutes are required to submit a 21-slide presentation via e-mail, in an Open Document Format (ODF), based on specified topics. And the submissions will be evaluated by an eminent jury, on the basis of pre-determined parameters. The contest will help the government and the schools in faster adoption of the ODF, which would further help in narrowing the digital divide.

What's in store for the winners?

While everyone is assured of a participation certificate, there are prizes for three winners in each of the categories. The winning school will be awarded the ODF Olympiad trophy and there's a Software Freedom trophy for the

school that wins the inter-country contest. What's more, there are also netbooks for the winners, awarded by IOTA (Institute for Open Technology and Application).

The complete evaluation process of the Olympiad has been visually outlined in the flowchart.

Topics for the participants

Category	Standard / Class	Presentation topic
I	Upto 5 th	The benefits of computers to my school
II	6 th , 7 th & 8 th	The benefits of Open Source Software to my school
III	9 th & 10 th	Open Standards: Freedom from the Digital Divide
IV	11 th & 12 th	The importance of Open Standards in e-Governance

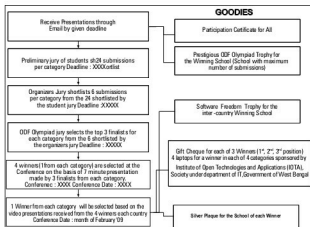
The ODF Olympiad is powered by...

The ODF Olympiad is a multi-stakeholder initiative being promoted by the government of Malaysia, the government of West Bengal, Sun Microsystems, GNU, the Free Software Foundation, the ODF Alliance, IIT Delhi, JNU, IIM Ahmedabad, the Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology (MAIT), IOTA (a society under the Department of IT, government of West Bengal), the ODF Alliance, OSDD, the Knowledge Commons, etc.

OpenOffice.org on LFY CD for Olympiad participants

OpenOffice.org is an office application suite available for a number of different computer operating systems. It is distributed as free software and written using the GTK toolkit. It supports the ISO/IEC standard Open Document Format (ODF) for data interchange as its default file format, as well as Microsoft Office formats, among others. The source code of the suite was released in July 2000 with the aim of reducing the dominant market share of Microsoft Office by providing a free and open alternative.

You can install OpenOffice.org, included with this issue's CD, from <media drive>/software/office/.



Flowchart: Evaluation process of ODF Olympiad 2009